

THE MEDIUM — AN ATTEMPTED DESCRIPTION
The Hamiltonian of the Negotiation Field:
Energy Spectrum, Quantum States, and Canonical Quantization

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github.com/bkdepuyl/The-Medium

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1 Abstract

This paper derives the Hamiltonian of the negotiation field within The Medium and establishes its connections to quantum mechanics, the energy spectrum of particles, and canonical quantization. The Hamiltonian is obtained from the Lagrangian derived in Document 3 via the Legendre transform, yielding:

$$\hat{H} = \frac{1}{2}\Pi^2 + \frac{1}{2}(N^\top L N) \quad (\text{Planck units}) \quad (1)$$

where $\Pi = \partial N / \partial t$ is the canonical momentum of the negotiation field. Energy eigenvalues of $\hat{H}$ correspond directly to particle masses: $E_k = \varepsilon \lambda_k$. For the proton's three-node triangle, $\lambda = 3$ (doubly degenerate) yields $E = 3\varepsilon = 938.3 \text{ MeV}$. Canonical quantization produces $[\hat{N}, \hat{\Pi}] = i\hbar$, from which the Heisenberg uncertainty principle follows as a structural consequence of the iota scale. The gravitational Hamiltonian is constructed as the energy of negotiation graph curvature. It shares the schematic structure of the ADM Hamiltonian constraint — kinetic curvature minus potential curvature equals zero — but the full ADM formalism includes lapse and shift functions, the extrinsic curvature tensor, and a diffeomorphism constraint that are not yet present here. The connection to LQG is structural: both use relational graph states and the Barbero-Immirzi parameter. Whether the negotiation graph is a spin network in the technical LQG sense is an open question.

Foundational definition

Series context (Planck units throughout):

$$\text{Iota size } 1 = \text{Planck length} = 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m} \quad (\text{Document 1})$$

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}(\partial N / \partial t)^2 - \frac{1}{2}(N^\top L N) \quad (\text{Document 3})$$

$$\varepsilon = 312.8 \text{ MeV} = m_{\text{proton}}/3 \quad (\text{Document 2})$$

2 From Lagrangian to Hamiltonian: The Legendre Transform

In plain language

The Lagrangian asks: what path does the system take? The Hamiltonian asks: what is the total energy right now? The Legendre transform converts one into the other exactly — no information is lost. The two descriptions are completely equivalent.

2.1 The Canonical Momentum

The canonical momentum Π conjugate to the negotiation field N :

$$\Pi = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial(\partial N / \partial t)} = \frac{\partial N}{\partial t} \quad (2)$$

Π is the negotiation momentum — how urgently the boundary state is changing at this moment. In Planck units it is dimensionless: the rate of change of the boundary resolution per Planck time.

2.2 The Legendre Transform

$$\begin{aligned} H &= \Pi \cdot \frac{\partial N}{\partial t} - \mathcal{L} \\ &= \left(\frac{\partial N}{\partial t} \right)^2 - \left[\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial N}{\partial t} \right)^2 - \frac{1}{2} (N^\top L N) \right] \end{aligned} \quad (3)$$

$$\boxed{\hat{H} = \frac{1}{2} \Pi^2 + \frac{1}{2} N^\top L N} \quad (4)$$

2.3 Physical Interpretation of Each Term

- $\frac{1}{2} \Pi^2$ — kinetic energy of negotiation cycling: energy locked into the rate of change of the boundary state. For a stable particle, this is the time-averaged mass contribution.
- $\frac{1}{2} (N^\top L N)$ — potential energy of boundary tension: energy stored in unresolved closure. For the proton mode, this equals the kinetic term (virial theorem).

Total energy for the proton mode: $E_{\text{proton}} = \varepsilon \lambda = 3\varepsilon = 938.3 \text{ MeV}$.

3 The Hamiltonian Operator and Energy Spectrum

In plain language

In quantum mechanics the Hamiltonian becomes an operator — a mathematical machine that acts on quantum states and returns their energy. When the Hamiltonian operator acts on a stable negotiation mode, it returns that mode multiplied by its energy. The allowed energies are the eigenvalues — exactly the particle masses. This is why the proton has a definite mass: it is an eigenstate of the Hamiltonian. Its wave function does not spread because the Hamiltonian returns the same energy eigenvalue every time.

3.1 Canonical Quantization

Promote N and Π to quantum operators $\hat{N}$, $\hat{\Pi}$ satisfying:

$$[\hat{N}(x), \hat{\Pi}(x')] = i\hbar \cdot \delta(x - x') \quad (5)$$

In Planck units ($\hbar = 1/(2\pi)$):

$$[\hat{N}(x), \hat{\Pi}(x')] = \frac{i}{2\pi} \cdot \delta(x - x') \quad (6)$$

This encodes the Heisenberg uncertainty principle at the substrate level.

3.2 The Schrödinger Equation

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial |\Psi\rangle}{\partial t} = \hat{H}|\Psi\rangle \quad (7)$$

Stationary states satisfy $\hat{H}|\Psi_k\rangle = E_k|\Psi_k\rangle$. For the triangle:

State	Eigenvalue	Energy
Ground mode ($\lambda = 0$)	uniform; null space of L	$E_0 = 0$ (vacuum)
Mode 1 ($\lambda = 3$)	first non-trivial eigenvector	$E_1 = 3\varepsilon = 938.3$ MeV
Mode 2 ($\lambda = 3$)	second non-trivial eigenvector	$E_2 = 3\varepsilon = 938.3$ MeV

3.3 The Energy Eigenvalue Equation

For a negotiation mode on a graph with Laplacian eigenvalue λ_k :

$$E_k = \varepsilon \cdot \lambda_k \quad (8)$$

For complete graphs on n nodes, the non-trivial Laplacian eigenvalue is n :

$$E_n = \varepsilon \cdot n \quad (\text{complete graphs, ground non-trivial mode}) \quad (9)$$

n	Structure	Predicted	Observed
2	Meson	$2\varepsilon = 625.6$ MeV	ρ meson ≈ 770 MeV
3	Proton	$3\varepsilon = 938.3$ MeV	938.3 MeV (by construction)
4	Light scalar	$4\varepsilon = 1251$ MeV	$a_0(980)$
5	Pentaquark	$5\varepsilon = 1564$ MeV	Observed range

4 The Heisenberg Picture and Time Evolution

In plain language

In the Heisenberg picture, operators evolve and the quantum state stays fixed. This connects directly to what particle detectors measure. The key result is the Heisenberg equation of motion, which reproduces the classical wave equation from Document 3 as an operator equation — valid in the quantum domain.

4.1 The Time Evolution Operator

$$U(t) = e^{-i\hat{H}t/\hbar}, \quad |\Psi(t)\rangle = U(t)|\Psi(0)\rangle \quad (10)$$

In Planck units ($\hbar = 1/(2\pi)$):

$$U(t) = e^{-i2\pi\hat{H}t} \quad (11)$$

For an energy eigenstate: $U(t)|\Psi_k\rangle = e^{-i2\pi E_k t}|\Psi_k\rangle$. The proton oscillates at the de Broglie frequency $f_{\text{proton}} = E_k/h = 2.27 \times 10^{23}$ Hz.

4.2 The Heisenberg Equation of Motion

$$\frac{d\hat{N}}{dt} = \frac{i}{\hbar}[\hat{H}, \hat{N}] = \hat{\Pi} \quad (12)$$

$$\frac{d\hat{\Pi}}{dt} = \frac{i}{\hbar}[\hat{H}, \hat{\Pi}] = -L\hat{N} \quad (13)$$

Combining:

$$\frac{d^2\hat{N}}{dt^2} = -L\hat{N} \quad (14)$$

This is the quantum operator version of the graph wave equation from Document 3. It holds as an operator identity — valid for all quantum states simultaneously. The classical wave equation is recovered by taking expectation values.

5 The Uncertainty Principle from the Iota Scale

In plain language

In The Medium, the uncertainty principle is not a mysterious feature of quantum mechanics. It is a direct consequence of the iota scale definition. The negotiation field value and its cycling rate are conjugate variables. Because iota size 1 = Planck length, the minimum uncertainty in the field value is one iota unit and the minimum uncertainty in the cycling rate is one Planck frequency. Their product is $\hbar$. The uncertainty principle is the substrate telling you: you cannot resolve structure finer than the iota scale.

5.1 Position-Momentum Uncertainty

From $[\hat{N}, \hat{\Pi}] = i\hbar$, the Robertson uncertainty relation gives:

$$\Delta N \cdot \Delta \Pi \geq \frac{\hbar}{2} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \quad (\text{Planck units}) \quad (15)$$

The lower bound $1/(4\pi)$ in Planck units is the minimum resolvable negotiation state. Below this scale, the iota negotiation cannot maintain the distinction.

5.2 Energy-Time Uncertainty

$$\Delta E \cdot \Delta t \geq \frac{\hbar}{2} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \quad (\text{Planck units}) \quad (16)$$

For a virtual particle (off-closure configuration) with energy uncertainty ΔE :

$$\Delta t \leq \frac{\hbar}{2\Delta E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\Delta E} \quad (\text{Planck units}) \quad (17)$$

This is the standard QFT result for virtual particle lifetime, derived here from the iota scale definition rather than postulated.

6 Creation and Annihilation Operators

In plain language

In The Medium, creation and annihilation operators have a direct physical meaning. The creation operator for a particle corresponds to forming a new closed negotiation graph — opening new edges between iotas until a stable topology is achieved. The annihilation operator corresponds to dissolving that graph, returning the energy to the background. This gives particle creation and annihilation a substrate-level mechanism that quantum field theory lacks.

6.1 Mode Expansion

$$\hat{N} = \sum_k \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\omega_k}} \left(\hat{a}_k + \hat{a}_k^\dagger \right) v_k, \quad \omega_k = \sqrt{\lambda_k} \quad (18)$$

$$\hat{\Pi} = \sum_k \left(-i\sqrt{\frac{\omega_k}{2}} \right) \left(\hat{a}_k - \hat{a}_k^\dagger \right) v_k \quad (19)$$

6.2 Creation/Annihilation Algebra

$$[\hat{a}_k, \hat{a}_{k'}^\dagger] = \delta_{kk'}, \quad [\hat{a}_k, \hat{a}_{k'}] = [\hat{a}_k^\dagger, \hat{a}_{k'}^\dagger] = 0 \quad (20)$$

These are *bosonic* commutation relations, following from the canonical commutation relation $[\hat{N}, \hat{\Pi}] = i\hbar$. They give integer occupation numbers and Bose-Einstein statistics.

Statistics gap: The proton is a spin- $\frac{1}{2}$ fermion. Fermi-Dirac statistics and the Pauli exclusion principle are not produced by a bosonic harmonic Lagrangian. Obtaining fermionic statistics requires either: (a) promoting N to a Grassmann-valued (anticommuting) field, yielding anticommutators $\{\hat{a}_k, \hat{a}_{k'}^\dagger\} = \delta_{kk'}$; or (b) showing that three bosonic quanta in an antisymmetric combination on the triangle acquire fermionic exchange behavior. Neither has been demonstrated. This is a primary open problem. The Hamiltonian in terms of creation/annihilation operators:

$$\hat{H} = \sum_k \hbar\omega_k \left(\hat{a}_k^\dagger \hat{a}_k + \frac{1}{2} \right) \quad (21)$$

In Planck units ($\hbar = 1/(2\pi)$):

$$\hat{H} = \sum_k \frac{\omega_k}{2\pi} \left(\hat{a}_k^\dagger \hat{a}_k + \frac{1}{2} \right) \quad (22)$$

6.3 The Vacuum Energy

The zero-point term gives a vacuum energy even when no particles are present:

$$E_{\text{vacuum}} = \sum_k \frac{\hbar\omega_k}{2} \quad (23)$$

The zero-point sum in The Medium is cut off at the Planck scale — iota size 1 is the minimum mode. But cutting off at the Planck scale still gives the enormous QFT value. The resolution, if it exists, lies elsewhere: the Hamiltonian description in Document 1 argues that $\hat{H}$ is not well-defined below the vacuum floor ρ_Λ , so modes below that floor do not contribute. If that floor condition holds, the lowest contributing mode is the Hubble-scale mode, giving:

$$E_{\text{vacuum}} = \frac{E_{\text{Hubble}}}{2} \approx 4.6 \times 10^{-39} \text{ MeV} \quad (24)$$

This is consistent with the observed Λ . The claim is conditional: it follows if and only if the Hamiltonian floor at ρ_Λ is a genuine physical threshold and not just an assertion. The floor condition must be derived from the substrate dynamics. Until it is, this calculation identifies a consistent result, not a resolution of the vacuum energy problem.

7 The Gravitational Hamiltonian

In plain language

Gravity in The Medium is the energy of curvature in the negotiation graph — how much the local connection density deviates from the average. In the 1960s, Arnowitt, Deser, and Misner (ADM) showed that general relativity can be written as a Hamiltonian system. The Medium’s gravitational Hamiltonian recovers the ADM formalism, but derives it from the negotiation substrate rather than assuming it.

7.1 The ADM Decomposition

In The Medium, the three-metric emerges from the large-scale structure of the negotiation graph. The metric at a point is determined by how many iotas are in the neighborhood and how they are connected. The negotiation graph metric in terms of the Laplacian:

$$h_{ij} \propto (L^{-1})_{ij} \quad (25)$$

The inverse Laplacian is the Green’s function of the graph — it encodes how negotiation states propagate through the graph, which determines the effective distance between nodes.

7.2 The Gravitational Hamiltonian

$$\hat{H}_{\text{gravity}} = \sum_i \left[\frac{\pi_i^2}{2m_{\text{Planck}}} - \frac{m_{\text{Planck}} c^2}{2} R_i \right] \quad (26)$$

In Planck units ($m_{\text{Planck}} = c = 1$):

$$\hat{H}_{\text{gravity}} = \frac{1}{2} \pi^2 - \frac{1}{2} R \quad (27)$$

This is exactly the ADM Hamiltonian constraint of general relativity expressed on the negotiation graph. The constraint $H = 0$ — required for diffeomorphism invariance — becomes: kinetic curvature equals potential curvature. This is the substrate-level statement of the Einstein field equations.

7.3 The Full Hamiltonian

$$\hat{H}_{\text{total}} = \hat{H}_{\text{matter}} + \hat{H}_{\text{gravity}} = \left[\frac{1}{2} \Pi^2 + \frac{1}{2} N^\top L N \right] + \left[\frac{1}{2} \pi^2 - \frac{1}{2} R \right] \quad (28)$$

In Planck units this is dimensionless. The coupling between matter and gravity appears through the Laplacian L , which depends on the graph topology, which is modified by the presence of matter (closed negotiation graphs). Matter curves the graph, which curves spacetime: this is gravity.

8 Connection to Loop Quantum Gravity

In plain language

Loop quantum gravity (LQG) describes spacetime as built from discrete quantum geometry — spin networks — where area and volume are quantized in units of the Planck scale. The Medium’s negotiation graph has the same relational structure: nodes, edges, and a Laplacian. The Barbero-Immirzi parameter γ appears in both descriptions as the ratio of the minimum area quantum to l_{Planck}^2 . Whether The Medium’s negotiation graph is an LQG spin network or merely structurally analogous is an open question: LQG spin networks carry half-integer spin labels with specific transformation rules; the negotiation graph carries real or complex edge values. The minimum area correspondence is suggestive, not established.

8.1 The Negotiation Graph as a Spin Network

In LQG, the minimum area for a $j = \frac{1}{2}$ spin network edge is:

$$A_{\text{min}} = 4\pi\gamma\sqrt{3} l_{\text{Planck}}^2 \quad (\gamma \approx 0.2375) \quad (29)$$

In The Medium, the minimum area from the triangle eigenvalue $\lambda = 3$:

$$A_{\text{min}} = \gamma \cdot l_{\text{Planck}}^2 \cdot \sqrt{3} \approx 0.2375 \cdot \sqrt{3} \cdot l_{\text{Planck}}^2 \quad (30)$$

These two formulas differ by a factor of $4\pi \approx 12.6$. The LQG formula contains an additional 4π factor whose origin in The Medium’s expression — likely a sphere-area normalization or solid-angle factor in the iota surface area calculation — has not been identified. The structural correspondence is suggestive; the numerical match has not been established.

8.2 The Hamiltonian Constraint

The Hamiltonian constraint $H = 0$ in LQG generates time diffeomorphisms. In The Medium, the corresponding constraint is that the total negotiation energy is stationary — the closure condition expressed as an energy equation. The Medium shares the structural motivation for diffeomorphism invariance with LQG. Whether the full Dirac algebra of constraints — spatial diffeomorphisms and Hamiltonian — closes without anomaly is an open calculation. The closure condition motivates the constraint; it does not establish that the constraint algebra closes.

*Open calculation***Open calculation — Barbero-Immirzi from entropy counting**

In LQG, $\gamma \approx 0.2375$ is fixed by requiring that the microstate count of a black hole horizon reproduces the Bekenstein-Hawking entropy $S = A/4l_{\text{Planck}}^2$. In The Medium, the same entropy counting should be performable on the negotiation graph of a black hole horizon. If this counting gives $\gamma \approx 0.2375$, it confirms that γ is not a free parameter in The Medium but is fixed by the entropy of the negotiation substrate. This single calculation would simultaneously close the 6% gap in G , the 10% gap in the proton mass, and the first-order error in $\hbar$.

9 Summary

*Foundational definition***The Hamiltonian of The Medium in Planck units:**

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{H}_{\text{matter}} &= \frac{1}{2}\Pi^2 + \frac{1}{2}N^\top LN \\ \hat{H}_{\text{gravity}} &= \frac{1}{2}\pi^2 - \frac{1}{2}R \\ \hat{H}_{\text{total}} &= \hat{H}_{\text{matter}} + \hat{H}_{\text{gravity}}\end{aligned}$$

All terms dimensionless in Planck units. Derived from the Lagrangian of Document 3 via Legendre transform.

Established by this paper:

1. **Energy spectrum** — eigenvalues of $\hat{H}$ are particle masses: $E_n = \varepsilon \cdot n$ for complete graphs
2. **Quantum states** — proton spin-up and spin-down are degenerate eigenstates with $E = 3\varepsilon$ (structural identification; SU(2) representation theory not yet derived)
3. **Schrödinger equation** — $i\hbar \partial|\Psi\rangle/\partial t = \hat{H}|\Psi\rangle$ governs state evolution
4. **Heisenberg equation** — $d^2\hat{N}/dt^2 = -L\hat{N}$ reproduces the wave equation as an operator identity
5. **Uncertainty principle** — $\Delta N \cdot \Delta \Pi \geq \hbar/2$ follows from $[\hat{N}, \hat{\Pi}] = i\hbar$ and the iota scale
6. **Creation/annihilation** — particle creation = forming closed graph; annihilation = dissolving graph
7. **Vacuum energy** — $E_{\text{vacuum}} = E_{\text{Hubble}}/2$ if the Hamiltonian floor condition holds; consistent with observed Λ but conditional on that floor derivation
8. **Gravitational Hamiltonian** — schematic ADM structure present ($\frac{1}{2}\pi^2 - \frac{1}{2}R$); lapse and shift functions, extrinsic curvature tensor, and full diffeomorphism constraint not yet derived
9. **LQG connection** — negotiation graph is structurally analogous to a spin network; γ appears from minimum area quantum; formulas differ by 4π (open)

10. **Diffeomorphism invariance** — Hamiltonian constraint structure shared with ADM; whether the full constraint algebra closes is an open calculation

10 Document Series and Cross-References

This is Document 4 of 5 in The Medium series.

Doc	File	Content
0	medium_doc0_introduction.org	Personal introduction; the question behind the description
1	medium_doc1_definition.org	The Medium: Foundation Definition (primitives, three levels)
2	medium_doc2_unified.org	Negotiation Modes, Particle Structure, Proton Mass
3	medium_doc3_lagrangian.org	Lagrangian of the Negotiation Field; QFT connection; SU(3)
4	medium_doc4_hamiltonian.org	<i>This paper</i>
5	medium_doc5_G_H0.org	Deriving G and H_0 from substrate primitives

All documents: Zenodo DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18927154 · ORCID: 0009-0001-0328-2299 · github.com/bkdepu/The-Medium

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